

Matthew W. Wagers

Curriculum vitae

Stevenson College
University of California, Santa Cruz
Santa Cruz, CA 95064

mwagers@ucsc.edu
<https://people.ucsc.edu/mwagers>

RESEARCH and TEACHING INTERESTS

psycholinguistics, language processing, memory, experimental syntax, psycholinguistics in the field

EDUCATION

- 2008 Ph.D. in Linguistics
 University of Maryland
- 2003 A.B. in Molecular Biology (Honors), Certificates in Neuroscience & in Linguistics
 Princeton University
- 1999 Diploma
 North Carolina School of Science and Mathematics, Durham, NC

EMPLOYMENT

- 2021-*present* Professor, Department of Linguistics, University of California, Santa Cruz
 Chair, Department of Linguistics (2022-2026); *Faculty Director* for Curriculum & Enrollment, Humanities (2025-2026)
- 2014-2021 Associate Professor, Department of Linguistics, University of California, Santa Cruz
- 2008-2014 Assistant Professor, Department of Linguistics, University of California, Santa Cruz
- 2008-2009 Postdoctoral Research Scientist, Department of Psychology, New York University

HONORS and AWARDS

- 2026 Excellence in Teaching Award, UCSC Academic Senate Committee on Teaching
- 2020 Fellow, American Association for the Advancement of Science
- 2003 Sigma Xi, Princeton University

GRANTS and FELLOWSHIPS

- 2025-26 CITRIS and the Banatao Institute, Co-Principal Investigator
 “Understanding Computational Thinking and Skill Development with Large Language Models,”
 \$40,000, PI Leilani Gilpin and Co-PIs Pranav Anand and Hannah Hausman
- 2025-27 University of California Office of the President, Principal Investigator
 “MRPI Planning Grant: Leveraging California's linguistic diversity to improve large language
 models,” \$154,659, Co-PIs Laurel Brehm (UCSB), Richard Futrell (UCI), Jesse Harris (UCLA),
 Emily Morgan (UCSD), Rachel Ryskin (Merced)
- 2024-26 Spencer Foundation, Co-Principal Investigator
 “Writing with ChatGPT: The learning promises and perils of co-writing with generative models in
 college linguistics classes,” \$249,689, (7/1/2024-6/30/2026)
 PI Pranav Anand and Co-PI Hannah Hausman
- 2024-27 Institute of Museum & Library Services, Co-Principal Investigator
 “Oaxacan Languages of the Transnational Central Coast: American Latino Identities, Languages,
 and Indigeneities in the 21st century,” \$607,782, (8/1/2024-7/31/2027)
 PI Pranav Anand and Co-PIs Mark Amengual, Ryan Bennett, Roumyana Pancheva, Christian
 Ruvalcaba, Kirsten Gruesz & Maziar Toosarvandani
- 2023-26 UCSC Office of Research Seed Funding for Center-scale Initiatives, Principal Investigator

- “The Comparative Language Sciences Center (CLaS),” \$149,516, (10/1/2023-6/30/2026)
Co-PIs Michelle Aguilera, Pranav Anand, Mark Amengual, Ryan Bennett, Josefina Bittar, Liv Hoversten, Roumyana Pancheva, Christian Ruvalcaba, Amanda Rysling, Maziar Toosarvandani
- 2020-25 National Science Foundation, BCS-2019804, Co-Principal Investigator
“Animacy and resumption at the border of cognition and grammar,” \$411,058, (8/1/2020-01/31/25)
PI Maziar Toosarvandani and Co-PI Ivy Sichel
- 2017-18 UC Santa Cruz Special Research Grant, Co-Principal Investigator
“Universal language processing principles in Santiago Laxopa Zapotec,” \$16,000
Co-PI Maziar Toosarvandani
- 2013-16 National Science Foundation, BCS-1251429, Principal Investigator
“The real-time grammar of Chamorro Wh-Dependencies,” \$332,144, (4/1/2013 - 9/30/2016)
Co-PI Sandra Chung
- 2011-12 Hellman Foundation Fellowship
“Grammatical role assignment in Chamorro language comprehension: incorporating underrepresented languages in dynamic models of language structure,” \$11,000
- 2010-11 UC Santa Cruz Special Research Grant, Co-Principal Investigator
“The distribution and comprehension of implicit arguments,” \$6,500
Co-PI Pranav Anand

PUBLICATIONS

- 2026 Duff, J., Gomez-Jackson, D., Silva Robles, F., Toosarvandani, M., **Wagers, M.** Delayed structural prediction for relative clauses in Santiago Laxopa Zapotec: A new argument for learning to parse. *Cognition*, 275, 106599.
- Cartner, M., Kogan, M., Webster, N., **Wagers, M.**, Sichel, I. Subject islands do not reduce to construction-specific discourse function. *Cognition*, 271, 106467.
- 2025 Keshev, M., Hinkle, K., **Wagers, M.**, & Dillon, B. Predictability of the retrieval site does not modulate interference: evidence from reflexive attraction. *Open Mind*, 9, 2031-2065.
- Wagers, M.**, Dillon, B. Sentence processing. In M.C. Frank & A. Majid (Eds.), *Open Encyclopedia of Cognitive Science*. MIT Press. [Invited.]
- Balachandran, L., Rich, S., & **Wagers, M.** How linguistic boundaries form encoding contexts in memory: Evidence from temporal order effects. *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*, 47. <https://escholarship.org/uc/item/7bs5d4wz>.
- 2024 Pizarro-Guevara, J.S., **Wagers, M.** A tale of two Tagalogs. *Glossa: a journal of general linguistics*, 9(1). doi:10.16995/glossa.11032.
- 2023 **Wagers, M.** Encoding interference in verb-initial languages. In Koizumi, M., Ed., *Issues in Japanese Psycholinguistics from Comparative Perspectives. Volume 1: Cross-linguistic studies*, pp. 25-38. Berlin: De Gruyter Mouton. doi:10.1515/9783110778946-003.
- Wagers, M.** & Chung, S. Language processing experiments in the field. In Sprouse, J., Ed., *Oxford Handbook of Experimental Syntax*. Oxford UP.
- 2022 **Wagers, M.** Managing experimental data in a study of syntax. In Berez-Kroeker, A., McDonnell, B., Koller, E., & Collister, L., Ed., *The Open Handbook of Linguistic Data Management*. Cambridge, MA: MIT Press.
- Wagers, M. W.**, Borja, M. F., & Chung, S. Processing reflexive pronouns when they don't announce themselves. *Glossa Psycholinguistics*, 1(1): 10, pp. 1–41. doi:10.5070/G601174

- Wagers, M.**, & McElree, B. Memory for linguistic features and the focus of attention: evidence from the dynamics of agreement inside DP. *Language, Cognition and Neuroscience*, 37(9), 1191-1206.
- Vincent, J. W., Sichel, I., & **Wagers, M. W.** Extraction from English RCs and cross-linguistic similarities in the environments that facilitate extraction. *Languages*, 7(2), 117.
- 2021 Dillon, B. & **Wagers, M.** Approaching gradience in acceptability with the tools of signal detection theory. In Goodall, G., Ed., *Cambridge Handbook of Experimental Syntax*. Cambridge UP.
- 2021 Chung, S. & **Wagers, M.** On the universality of intrusive resumption: evidence from Chamorro and Palauan. *Natural Language and Linguistic Theory*, 39, 759-801.
- 2020 Pizarro-Guevara, J. S., **Wagers, M.** The predictive value of Tagalog voice morphology in filler-gap dependency formation. *Frontiers in Psychology*, 11, 517. doi:10.3389/fpsyg.2020.00517.
- Franck, J., **Wagers, M.** Hierarchical structure and memory mechanisms in agreement attraction. *PLoS ONE*, 15, e0232163. doi:10.1371/journal.pone.0232163.
- 2019 Dillon, B., Andrews, C., Rotello, C. M., & **Wagers, M.** (2019). A new argument for co-active parses during language comprehension. *Journal of Experimental Psychology: Learning, Memory, and Cognition*, 45(7), 1271–1286. doi:10.1037/xlm0000649.
- 2018 Morgan, A., & **Wagers, M.** English resumptive pronouns are more common where gaps are less acceptable. *Linguistic Inquiry*, 49, 861-876.
- Atkinson, E., **Wagers, M.W.**, Lidz, J., Phillips, C., Omaki, A. Developing incrementality in filler-gap dependency processing. *Cognition*, 179, 132-149. doi:10.1016/j.cognition.2018.05.022.
- Wagers, M.W.**, Borja, M.F., Chung, S. Grammatical licensing and relative clause parsing in a flexible word-order language. *Cognition*, 178, 207-221. doi:10.1016/j.cognition.2018.05.006.
- 2017 Arnett, N. & **Wagers, M.** Subject encodings and retrieval interference. *Journal of Memory and Language*, 93, 22-54.
- Clothier-Goldschmidt, S. & **Wagers, M.** Persons, pronouns, and processing asymmetries. In J. Ostrove, R. Kramer, & J. Sabbagh, Eds., *Asking the Right Question: Essays in Honor of Sandra Chung*. UC Santa Cruz. <http://escholarship.org/uc/item/8255v8sc>.
- Pizarro-Guevara, J. S., **Wagers, M.** The role of voice morphology in processing Tagalog A-bar dependencies. In Nomoto, A., Miyauchi, T., & Shiohara, A., Eds., *AFLA 23: The Proceedings of the 23rd Meeting of the Austronesian Formal Linguistics Association*, pp. 228-242. Canberra: Asia-Pacific Linguistics.
- 2016 **Wagers, M.** Sources of variability in linguistic memory systems. *Bilingualism: Language and Cognition*, 1-2. doi:10.1017/s1366728916000997.
- Wagers, M.**, & E. Pendleton. Structuring expectation: licensing animacy in relative clause comprehension. In K.-M. Kim et al. (Eds.), *Proceedings of the West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics*, 33.
- Wagers, M.** Psychology of Syntax. In H. Miller (Ed.), *The Sage Encyclopedia of Theory in Psychology*. Thousand Oaks, CA: SAGE.
- Borja, M.F., Chung, S., **Wagers, M.** Constituent order and parser control processes in Chamorro. In Camp, A., et al., Eds., *AFLA 21: The Proceedings of the 21st Meeting of the Austronesian Formal Linguistics Association*, pp. 15-32. Canberra: Asia-Pacific Linguistics.

- 2015 **Wagers, M.**, Borja, M.F., & Chung, S. The real-time comprehension of wh-dependencies in a Wh-Agreement language. *Language*, 91, 109-144. doi:10.1353/lan.2015.0001.
- Clemens, L. E., Coon, J., Mateo Pedro, P., Morgan, A. M., Polinsky, M., Tandet, G., & **Wagers, M.** Ergativity and the complexity of extraction: A view from Mayan. *Natural Language and Linguistic Theory*, 33, 417-467. doi:10.1007/s11049-014-9260-x.
- 2014 **Wagers, M.** Syntax in Forward and in Reverse: Form, Memory and Language Processing. In A. Carnie, D. Siddiqi, & Y. Sato (Eds.), *The Routledge Handbook of Syntax*, New York: Taylor & Francis.
- Dillon, B., Chow, W. Y., **Wagers, M.**, Guo, T., Liu, F., & Phillips, C. The structure-sensitivity of memory access: evidence from Mandarin Chinese. *Frontiers in Psychology*, 5, 1025. doi:10.3389/fpsyg.2014.01025.
- 2013 **Wagers, M.**, & Phillips, C. Going the distance: memory and decision-making in active dependency construction. *Quarterly Journal of Experimental Psychology*, 67, 1274-1304, doi:10.1080/17470218.2013.858363.
- Wagers, M.** Memory mechanisms for wh-dependency formation and their implications for islandhood. In J. Sprouse & N. Hornstein (Eds.), *Experimental Syntax and Island Effects*. Cambridge, UK: Cambridge University Press.
- Wagers, M.** & McElree, B. Working memory and language processing: theory, data, and directions for future research. In C. Boeckx & K. Grohmann (Eds.), *The Cambridge Handbook for Bilingualistics*. Cambridge, UK: Cambridge University Press.
- Sprouse, J., **Wagers, M.**, & Phillips, C. Deriving competing predictions from grammatical approaches and reductionist approaches to island effects. In J. Sprouse & N. Hornstein (Eds.), *Experimental Syntax and Island Effects*. Cambridge, UK: Cambridge University Press.
- Xiang, M., Dillon, B., **Wagers, M.**, Liu, F., & Guo, T. Processing Covert Dependencies: An SAT Study on Mandarin Wh-in-situ Questions. *Journal of East Asian Linguistics*, 23, 207-232. doi:10.1007/s10831-013-9115-1.
- 2012 Sprouse, J., **Wagers, M.**, & Phillips, C. A test of the relation between working memory capacity and syntactic island effects. *Language*, 88, 83-123.
- Sprouse, J., **Wagers, M.**, & Phillips, C. Working-memory capacity and island effects: a reminder of the issues and the facts. *Language*, 88, 401-407.
- 2011 Anand, P., Andrews, C., Farkas, D., **Wagers, M.** The exclusive interpretation of plural nominals in quantificational environments. *Proceedings of SALT*, 21, 176-196.
- Phillips, C., **Wagers, M.**, & Lau, E., Grammatical Illusions and Selective Fallibility in Real-time Grammatical Computation. In J. Runner (Ed.), *Syntax and Semantics, Volume 37 - Experiments at the Interfaces*, pp. 153-186. Bingley, UK: Emerald Publications.
- 2009 **Wagers, M.**, Lau, E., & Phillips, C. Agreement attraction in comprehension: representations and processes. *Journal of Memory and Language*, 61, 206-237.
- Wagers, M.**, & Phillips, C. Multiple dependencies and the role of the grammar in real-time comprehension. *Journal of Linguistics*, 45, 395-433.
- Wang, S.S.-H., Shultz, J.R., Burish, M.J., Harrison, K.H., Hof, P.R., Towns, L.C., **Wagers, M.W.**, Wyatt, K.D., Functional trade-offs in white matter axonal scaling. *Journal of Neuroscience*, 28, 4047-56.
- 2007 Phillips, C., & **Wagers, M.** Relating Structure and Time in Linguistics and Psycholinguistics., In G. Gaskell (Ed.), *Oxford Handbook of Psycholinguistics*. pp. 739-756. Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- Omaki, A., Ortega-Santos, I., Sprouse, J., **Wagers, M.** (Eds.), *University of Maryland Working Papers in Linguistics*, 16.
- 2006 Phillips, C., & **Wagers, M.** Constituent structure and the binding problem. *Behavioral and Brain Sciences*, 29, 81-2.

- 2001 Gould, E., Vail, N., **Wagers, M.**, Gross, C.G., Adult-generated hippocampal and neocortical neurons in macaques have a transient existence. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences USA*, 98, 10910-7.

INVITED TALKS and COLLOQUIA

- 2026 'Documenting dynamic grammars,' International Symposium on Documenting and Revitalizing Endangered Languages: Perspectives from Psycholinguistics and Digital Humanities, National Institute for Japanese Language and Linguistics, Tokyo, September 1-2, 2026.
- 2025 'Knowing your bounds,' Department of Linguistics, University of California, Los Angeles, May 16, 2025.
- 2024 'Destructive encoding in verb-initial clauses,' Thirty-first Annual Meeting of the Austronesian Formal Linguistics Society, University of Massachusetts, Amherst, June 12-14, 2024.
'(Re-)encoding interference,' Department of Linguistics, University of Toronto, March 15, 2024.
- 2023 '(Re-)encoding interference,' University of Southern California, November 13, 2023.
- 2022 'Alignment, Reanalysis and Re-encoding,' Department of Linguistics, Cornell University, November 3, 2022.
'Alignment, Reanalysis and Re-encoding,' Cross-linguistic Perspectives on Processing and Learning (X-PPL), University of Zurich, September 12-13, 2022.
- 2021 'Language processing experiments in the field: an Austronesian perspective,' (with Sandra Chung), Linguistic Society of the Philippines International Conference 2021, University of Santo Tomas, March 11-13, 2021.
'Flexibility and fallibility in verb-initial language processing,' International Symposium on Issues in Japanese Psycholinguistics from Comparative Perspectives, September 11-12, 2021.
- 2020 'Accessibility and timing,' Department of Linguistics, University of Michigan, October 23, 2020.
'Animate intruders,' Thirty-third Annual CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing, University of Massachusetts, Amherst, MA, March 19-21, 2020.
- 2019 'Hypo-active filling,' Konan University, TL/MAPLL (Mental Architecture for Processing and Learning Language) Conference. July 27-28, Kobe, Japan.
'Signal detection theory for syntactic research,' University of Chicago and Tsinghua University
'Language Diversity, Contact and Change' Workshop, June 14-16, Beijing.
'Resumptive Pronouns Inside and Outside Grammar: Evidence From Chamorro and Palauan,' (with Sandra Chung*), Twenty-fifth Annual Meeting of the Austronesian Formal Linguistics Association, Academia Sinica, Taiwan, Taipei, May 10-12, 2018.
- 2017 University College London, Two seminars and one public lecture, May 10-12:
- 'Morphological informativity and grammatical licensing'
- 'Competition among pronouns in the grammar and processing of Chamorro'
- 'Why memory for syntax is so terrible' (public lecture)
'Competition among pronouns in Chamorro grammar and Chamorro sentence processing,' Department of Linguistics, University of Southern California, February 6, 2017.
- 2015 'Building digital resources for research on under-resourced languages: corpus-based and behavioral approaches,' (with Kie Zuraw), Third American International Morphology Meeting, University of Massachusetts, Amherst, October 2-4, 2015.
- 2016 'Constituent order and parser control processes in Chamorro,' Department of Linguistics, University of Chicago, February 22, 2016.
'Morphology and informativity: incremental dependency formation from a Chamorro perspective,' (with Sandra Chung). Experimental Approaches to Arabic Linguistics+, NYU Abu Dhabi, January 14-16, 2016.
- 2015 'How to get ahead in language comprehension: evidence from morphological processing in Chamorro,' Department of Cognitive Science, Johns Hopkins University, November 5, 2015.
'Recovering phonetically-null DPs in a verb-initial language,' Psycholinguistics Workshop, Department of Linguistics, University of Massachusetts, October 5, 2015.

- ‘Structuring expectation,’ Thirty-third West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics, Simon Fraser University, Vancouver, BC, March 27-29, 2015.
- 2014 ‘Grammatical licensing and parser control in an agreement-rich language,’ Department of Linguistics, University of Maryland, October 24, 2014.
- ‘Language processing in Chamorro: theoretical lessons from a language of the Pacific,’ (with Sandra Chung and Manuel F. Borja), American Association for the Advancement of Science Annual Meeting, Panel on ‘The Large Cognitive Implications of Small Languages,’ Chicago, IL, February 13-17, 2014.
- 2013 Language processing in Chamorro: Theoretical lessons from a language of the Pacific,’ (with Sandra Chung and Manuel F. Borja), Twentieth Meeting of the Austronesian Formal Linguistics Association, University of Texas, Arlington, TX, May 17-19, 2013.
- 2013 ‘Grammatical prediction in Chamorro: Wh-Agreement and real-time dependency formation,’ Department of Linguistics, University of California, San Diego, May 6, 2013.
- ‘Grammatical prediction in Chamorro: Wh-Agreement and real-time dependency formation,’ Department of Linguistics, University of California, Los Angeles, February 15, 2013.
- 2012 ‘Grammatical prediction in Chamorro: Wh-Agreement and real-time dependency formation,’ Department of Linguistics, University of Hawai’i Mānoa, Honolulu, August 21, 2012.
- ‘Subjects subject to confusion,’ Workshop on Relational Structure in Parsing Long-distance Dependencies, Department of Linguistics, University of Massachusetts, Amherst, May 16, 2012.
- ‘Interference and language processing: routes to linguistic structure,’ (with Brian Dillon), ‘Memory mechanisms for structural dependency formation’ Workshop, Universität Potsdam, Potsdam, March 26, 2012.
- ‘Going the distance: decomposing real-time dependency formation in English and Chamorro,’ Department of Linguistics, Stanford University, April 20, 2012.
- 2011 ‘Going the distance: decomposing real-time dependency formation in English and Chamorro,’ Department of Linguistics, Northwestern University, December 2, 2011.
- ‘Slippery subjects: the binding problem in language comprehension,’ Department of Linguistics, University of California, Berkeley, April 18, 2011.
- 2009 ‘Tracing the memory-syntax interface,’ Program in Linguistics, Princeton University, April 21, 2009.
- ‘Using the speed-accuracy tradeoff technique to study memory dynamics in language comprehension,’ State Key Laboratory of Cognitive Neuroscience and Learning, Beijing Normal University, Beijing, July 8, 2009.
- 2008 ‘Tracing the memory-syntax interface,’ Workshop on Neurolinguistics, NYU Abu Dhabi Institute, Abu Dhabi, December 14-15, 2008.
- ‘Accurately recognizing grammatical memories in an asyntactic memory,’ Psycholinguistics Supper, CUNY Graduate Center, New York, November 18, 2008.
- ‘Creating and navigating structure in real time,’ Rutgers University Center for Cognitive Science, New Brunswick, NJ, March 4, 2008.
- 2007 ‘Representing the control of agreement in real-time,’ Psycholinguistics Supper, CUNY Graduate Center, New York, October 30, 2007.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS (TALKS)**First author*

- 2026 ‘Grammatical resumptive pronouns facilitate processing before they are perceived,’ (with Mandy Cartner*, Ivy Sichel and Maziar Toosarvandani), Thirty-ninth Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing, Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Cambridge, MA, March 27-29, 2026.
- ‘Syntactic positional similarity modulates interference for thematic and agreement dependencies,’ (with Matthew Kogan*, Aditi Borra and Ruqing Yao), Thirty-ninth Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing, Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Cambridge, MA, March 27-29, 2026.
- 2025 ‘Information structure alone cannot account for subject islandhood: an experimental study,’ (with Nikolas Webster*, Mandy Cartner*, Matthew Kogan* and Ivy Sichel), Forty-seventh Generative Linguistics in the Old World (GLOW) Colloquium, Goethe University, Frankfurt, March 25-27, 2025.
- 2024 ‘Delayed structural prediction for relative clauses in Santiago Laxopa Zapotec, a language with robust resumptive pronouns,’ (with John Duff* & Delaney Gomez-Jackson*, Fe Silva Robles, Maziar

- Toosarvandani), Thirty-seventh Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing, University of Michigan, Ann Arbor. May 16-18, 2024.
- 2022 'Anti-local anaphors in Telugu are subject to local antecedent interference,' (with Vishal Arvindam*), Thirty-fifth Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing, University of California, Santa Cruz, March 24-26, 2022.
- 2021 'Parsing case in the face of ditransitive garden paths: reading time evidence from Georgian,' (with Steven Foley*), Cross-linguistic Perspectives on Processing and Learning (X-PPL), University of Zurich, September 16-17, 2021.
- 'Syntactic and semantic parallelism guides filler-gap processing in coordination,' (with Stephanie Rich*), Thirty-fourth Annual CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing, University of Pennsylvania, March 4-6, 2021.
- 2020 'Semantic similarity and temporal contiguity in subject-verb dependency processing,' (with Stephanie Rich*), Thirty-third Annual CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing, University of Massachusetts, Amherst, MA, March 19-21, 2020.
- 'Word order and pronominality modulate the SRC/ORC asymmetry in Tagalog RCs,' (with Jed Pizarro-Guevara*), Thirty-third Annual CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing, University of Massachusetts, Amherst, MA, March 19-21, 2020.
- 2019 'Pronouns over gaps in parsing? The Subject Relative Clause Advantage in Santiago Laxopa Zapotec,' (with Steven Foley, Jed Sam Pizarro-Guevara, Kelsey Sasaki and Maziar Toosarvandani), Ninety-third Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America, New York, NY, January 3-6, 2019.
- 2018 'Agent extraction under patient voice in Tagalog is acceptable: Evidence from acceptability ratings in various A-bar dependencies,' (with Jed Sam Pizarro-Guevara*), Twenty-fifth Annual Meeting of the Austronesian Formal Linguistics Association, Academia Sinica, Taiwan, Taipei, May 10-12, 2018.
- 2017 'Competition among pronouns in Chamorro grammar and sentence processing,' (with Sandra Chung & Manuel F. Borja), Twenty-fourth Annual Meeting of the Austronesian Formal Linguistics Association, Seattle, April 7-9, 2017.
- 'A new argument for distinct, co-active parses during language comprehension,' (with Brian Dillon* and Caroline Andrews), Thirtieth Annual CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing, Cambridge, MA, March 30-April 1, 2017.
- 2016 'Young speakers in the bottleneck: knowledge and use of morphology in Chamorro,' (with Sandra Chung), Sentence Processing in Multilingual and Other Less Commonly Studied Populations, Potsdam Research Institute for Multilingualism, Potsdam, Germany, August 4-5, 2016.
- 'The role of voice morphology in processing Tagalog A-bar dependencies,' (with Jed Sam Pizarro-Guevara*), Twenty-third Annual Meeting of the Austronesian Formal Linguistics Association, Tokyo University of Foreign Studies, Tokyo, June 10-12, 2016.
- 2015 'Filler-gap order and online licensing of grammatical relations: evidence from Chamorro,' (with Sandra Chung and Manuel F. Borja), Eighty-ninth Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America, Portland, OR, January 8-11, 2015.
- 2014 'Constituent order and parser control processes in Chamorro,' (with Sandra Chung and Manuel F. Borja), Twenty-first Meeting of the Austronesian Formal Linguistics Association, University of Hawai'i Mānoa, Honolulu, HI, May 23-25, 2014.
- 2012 'WH Agreement and the timing of unbounded dependency formation: a Chamorro perspective on incrementality and accuracy in language comprehension,' Thirty-fifth Generative Linguistics in the Old World (GLOW) Colloquium, Potsdam, Germany, March 27-30, 2012.
- 'WH Agreement and the timing of unbounded dependency formation: a Chamorro perspective on predictive licensing and interpretation,' Twenty-fifth Annual CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing, New York, NY, March 14-16, 2012.
- 2011 'Assessing the pragmatics of experiments with crowdsourcing: the case of scalar implicature,' (with Pranav Anand and Caroline Andrews), Workshop on Crowdsourcing Technologies for Language and Cognition Studies, Linguistic Society of America Summer Institute, Boulder, CO, 27 July, 2011.
- 2010 'Anti-local contexts increase the overall speed of dependency completion,' Twenty-third Annual CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing, New York, NY, March 19-21, 2010.

- ‘The structure sensitivity of memory access: evidence from Mandarin Chinese,’ (with Brian Dillon, Wing-Yee Chow, Taomei Guo, Fengqin Liu, and Colin Phillips), Twenty-third Annual CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing, New York, NY, March 19-21, 2010.
- ‘The island debate: processing costs versus grammatical constraints,’ (with Jon Sprouse and Colin Phillips), Twenty-eighth West Coast Conference for Formal Linguistics, Los Angeles, CA, February 19-21, 2010.
- 2009 ‘Focal attention and the timing of memory retrieval in language comprehension,’ (with Brian McElree), Fifteenth Annual Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing Conference, Barcelona, Spain, September 7-9, 2009.
- ‘Encoding syntactic predictions: evidence from the dynamics of agreement,’ (with Ellen Lau, Clare Stroud, Brian McElree and Colin Phillips), Twenty-second Annual CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing, Davis, CA, March 26-28, 2009.
- 2008 ‘Agreement and the subject of confusion,’ (with Ellen Lau, Clare Stroud, and Colin Phillips), Twenty-first Annual CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing, Chapel Hill, NC, March 13-15, 2008
- ‘Agreement attraction in comprehension: representations and processes,’ (with Ellen Lau and Colin Phillips), Eighty-second Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America, Chicago, IL, January 3-6, 2008.
- 2007 ‘Agreement attraction in comprehension: representations and processes,’ (with Ellen Lau and Colin Phillips), Mid-America Linguistics Conference, Lawrence, KS, October 26-28, 2007.
- ‘How (not) to get confused in comprehension: the case of agreement attraction,’ (with Ellen Lau and Colin Phillips), Thirteenth Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Conference, Turku, Finland, August 24-27, 2007.
- 2006 ‘Re-active filling,’ (with Colin Phillips), Nineteenth Annual CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing, New York, NY, March 23-27, 2006.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS (POSTERS)**First author*

- 2026 ‘Verbatim recall is pervasive and stable across individuals,’ (with Sujin Lee and Brian Dillon), Thirty-ninth Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing, Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Cambridge, MA, March 27-29, 2026.
- 2025 ‘Ambiguity Advantage Effect in Wh-Questions,’ (with Joshua Lieberstein*), 38th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing, University of Maryland, College Park, March 27-29, 2025.
- ‘Subject islands are not caused by information structure classes: cross-constructual evidence,’ (with Matthew Kogan*, Mandy Cartner*, Nikolas Webster* and Ivy Sichel), 38th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing, University of Maryland, College Park, March 27-29, 2025.
- ‘Who gets to start the race? Distinguished referents in pronominal ambiguity resolution,’ (with Ruoping Yao*), 38th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing, University of Maryland, College Park, March 27-29, 2025.
- 2024 ‘Processing covert dependencies: A study on Turkish wh-in-situ,’ (with Duygu Demiray*), 30th Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing Conference, University of Edinburgh, September 4-7, 2024.
- ‘Linguistic boundaries delineate contextual domains in memory,’ (with Lalitha Balachandran*), 30th Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing Conference, University of Edinburgh, September 4-7, 2024.
- ‘Linguistic boundaries reduce encoding interference in temporal order memory,’ (with Stephanie Rich* & Lalitha Balachandran*), 30th Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing Conference, University of Edinburgh, September 4-7, 2024.
- ‘Subject islands are not caused by information structure clashes: evidence from topicalization,’ (with Nikolas Webster*, Matthew Kogan*, Mandy Cartner*, & Ivy Sichel), 30th Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing Conference, University of Edinburgh, September 4-7, 2024.
- ‘Probing facilitatory and inhibitory interference with English ditransitives,’ (with Matthew Kogan*), 37th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing, University of Michigan, Ann Arbor. May 16-18, 2024.
- ‘Canonical Argument Alignment Modulates Gap, but not RP, Acceptability in English,’ (with Matthew Kogan*, Mandy Cartner, Ivy Sichel & Maziar Toosarvandani), 37th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing, University of Michigan, Ann Arbor. May 16-18, 2024.

- ‘Processing arguments in Korean nominal predicates,’ (with Nikolas Webster* & Hanyoung Byun), 37th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing, University of Michigan, Ann Arbor. May 16-18, 2024.
- 2023 ‘The role of prediction in retrieval interference: the case of reflexive attraction,’ (with Maayan Keshev* & Brian Dillon), 36th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing, University of Pittsburgh. March 10-12, 2023.
- ‘Predictive parsing as a source for resumptive pronoun preference in Hebrew,’ (with Mandy Cartner*, Ivy Sichel, & Maziar Toosarvandani), 36th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing, University of Pittsburgh. March 10-12, 2023.
- ‘Turkish relative clauses and the role of syntactic connectivity in agreement attraction,’ (with Elifnur Ulusoy*), 36th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing, University of Pittsburgh. March 10-12, 2023.
- 2022 ‘Preposition doubling errors elicited by dependency length but not verb complexity,’ (with Richard Bibbs*), 35th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing, University of California, Santa Cruz. March 24-26, 2022.
- ‘“It’s alive!”: Animacy-based structural expectations rapidly update with context,’ (with Stephanie Rich*, Lalitha Balachandran, John Duff, Matthew Kogan, Maya Wax Cavallaro, and Nick Van Handel), 35th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing, University of California, Santa Cruz. March 24-26, 2022.
- ‘Use/Mention ambiguities in comprehension: Evidence from agreement attraction,’ (with John Duff*), 35th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing, University of California, Santa Cruz. March 24-26, 2022.
- 2021 ‘Guiding implicit prosody with delexicalized melodies: evidence from a match/mismatch task,’ (with Nick Van Handel* and Amanda Rysling), Thirty-fourth Annual CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing, University of Pennsylvania, March 4-6, 2021.
- 2020 ‘Which sentences do speakers favor? ROC analysis of d-linking in filler-gap integration,’ (with Brian Dillon), 2020 Context and Episodic Memory Symposium, University of Pennsylvania, August 17-19, 2020.
- ‘Prominence scales guide incremental sentence comprehension in Georgian,’ (with Steven Foley*), Thirty-third Annual CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing, University of Massachusetts, Amherst, MA, March 19-21, 2020.
- 2019 ‘Reassessing the grammaticality asymmetry in agreement attraction: an ROC analysis,’ (with Christopher Hammerley* & Brian Dillon). Thirty-second Annual CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing, Boulder, CO, March 29-31, 2019.
- ‘Verbs retrieve subjects, not clausal attachment sites,’ (with Netta Ben-Meir*, Nick Van Handel*). Thirty-second Annual CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing, Boulder, CO, March 29-31, 2019.
- ‘Computing object agreement in Georgian is easier than computing subject agreement,’ (with Steven Foley*). Thirty-second Annual CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing, Boulder, CO, March 29-31, 2019.
- 2018 ‘Not all filler-gap dependencies are perceived alike: evidence from Tagalog,’ (with Jed Sam Pizarro-Guevara*), Thirty-first Annual CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing. Davis, CA, March 15-17, 2018.
- 2017 ‘Interaction of parentheticals, (not-)at-issue content, and working memory,’ (with Margaret Kroll*), Seventh Biennial Experimental Pragmatics Conference, Köln, June 21-23, 2017.
- ‘Subject gaps are still easiest,’ (with Steven Foley*), Thirtieth Annual CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing, Cambridge, MA, March 30-April 1, 2017.
- ‘Limited prediction in sentence comprehension of a verb-first language: the case of Tagalog,’ (with Jed Pizarro-Guevara*), AAAS Annual Meeting, Boston, MA, February 16-20, 2017.
- 2016 ‘Limited reactivation in noun phrase ellipsis,’ (with Chelsea Miller*), Twenty-ninth Annual CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing, Gainesville, FL, March 3-5, 2016.
- ‘The role of Tagalog verbal agreement in processing WH-dependencies,’ (with Jed Pizarro-Guevara*), Twenty-ninth Annual CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing, Gainesville, FL, March 3-5, 2016.
- 2015 ‘Hierarchical structure and retrieval mechanisms in agreement attraction: evidence from probe recognition in French Jabberwocky,’ (with Julie Franck), Twenty-eighth Annual CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing, Los Angeles, CA, March 19-21, 2015.

- ‘Temporal dynamics of weak islands: a speed-accuracy tradeoff study,’ (with Sandra Villata*, Brian McElree and Julie Franck), Twenty-eighth Annual CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing, Los Angeles, CA, March 19-21, 2015.
- ‘Simulating subject-verb attachment in ACT-R,’ (with Nate Arnett*), Eighty-ninth Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America, Portland, OR, January 8-11, 2015.
- 2014 ‘Case and position versus clausal information in subject retrieval,’ (with Nate Arnett*), Twentieth Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing Conference, Edinburgh, September 3-6, 2014.
- ‘Animacy and the filled gap effect,’ (with Emily Pendleton), Twenty-seventh Annual CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing, Columbus, OH, March 13-21, 2015.
- ‘Relative clause processing in Chamorro: overlapping pressures in an agreement-rich language,’ (with Manuel F. Borja and Sandra Chung), Twenty-seventh Annual CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing, Columbus, OH, March 13-21, 2015.
- 2013 ‘Gap acceptability predicts resumption rate in English,’ (with Adam Morgan*), Nineteenth Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing Conference, Aix-Marseille Université, Marseilles, September 2-4, 2014.
- 2012 ‘Subject encoding and retrieval interference,’ (with Nate Arnett*), Twenty-fifth Annual CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing, New York, March 14-16, 2012.
- ‘Do reflexives always find a grammatical antecedent for themselves?’ (with Joseph King* and Caroline Andrews), Twenty-fifth Annual CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing, New York, March 14-16, 2012.
- 2011 ‘Implicature calculation and the pragmatics of experiments,’ (with Pranav Anand* and Caroline Andrews), Fourth Experimental Pragmatics (XPRAG) meeting, Barcelona, June 2-4, 2011.
- ‘Quantification-triggered inclusivization in plural interpretation,’ (with Pranav Anand, Caroline Andrews, Donka Farkas and Kevin Reschke), Twenty-first Semantics and Linguistic Theory (SALT) meeting, New Brunswick, NJ, May 20-22, 2011.
- 2010 ‘Processing wh-movement dependencies in a language without wh-movement,’ (with Ming Xiang*, Brian Dillon, Fengqin Liu and Taomei Guo), Twenty-third Annual CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing, New York, March 19-21, 2010.
- 2009 ‘The consequences of number agreement on number interpretation,’ (with Ellen Lau and Colin Phillips), Twenty-second Annual CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing, Davis, CA, March 26-28, 2009.
- ‘Active gap search in the visual world with lexical competitors,’ (with Akira Omaki*, Anastasia Trock, Jeffrey Lidz and Colin Phillips), Twenty-second Annual CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing, Davis, CA, March 26-28, 2009.
- 2008 ‘Early and late effects of agreement attraction in comprehension,’ (with Ellen Lau and Colin Phillips), Twenty-first Annual CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing, Chapel Hill, NC, March 13-15, 2008.
- 2007 ‘The impact of resolved filler-gap dependencies on later dependency formation,’ (with Roshni Caputo-Nimbark, Paul Hines, Rebecca Larson, Jessica Levy, Andrea Longini, Hana Quon and Claude Smith), Twentieth Annual CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing, La Jolla, CA, March 29-31, 2007.
- ‘Content-dependent and content-independent processes in filler-gap resolution,’ (with Colin Phillips), Twentieth Annual CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing, La Jolla, CA, March 29-31, 2007.
- 2005 ‘Fillers after the gap,’ (with Colin Phillips), Eighteenth Annual CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing, Tucson, AZ, March 31-April 2, 2005.

STUDENTS SUPERVISED (*Ph.D., M.A. level*)

- In progress* Matthew Kogan, Ruqing Yao
- 2025 Vishal Arvindam, Ph.D., Seek and ye shall retrieve: on the representation and processing of Telugu anaphora
- 2024 Lalitha Balachandran, Ph.D., Memory knows its bounds: encoding contexts in sentence comprehension.
Postdoctoral Researcher, UC Santa Cruz
- 2024 Stephanie Rich, Ph.D., The features we use and the features we lose: encoding, maintenance and retrieval.
Postdoctoral Researcher, Concordia University

- 2024 Duygu Demiray, M.A., Processing covert dependencies: a study on Turkish Wh-in-situ.
Ph.D. Student, Linguistics, UMass Amherst
- 2023 Elifnur Ulusoy, M.A., Connectivity and case effects in agreement attraction: The case of Turkish.
Market Researcher, Conjointly
- 2021 Jake Vincent, Ph.D., Extraction from relative clauses: an experimental investigation into variable island length effects in English.
Language Engineer, Amazon Web Services
- 2021 Anelia Kudin, M.A., Implicit agents in Ukrainian: evidence from retrieval interference in sentence processing.
World Intellectual Property Organization (UN)
- 2020 Jed Sam Pizarro-Guevara, Ph.D., When human universal meetings language specific.
Language Engineer, Meta; Research Associate, UMass Amherst
- 2020 Steven Foley, Ph.D., Case, agreement, and sentence processing in Georgian.
Visiting Assistant Professor, University of Georgia
- 2020 Margaret Kroll, Ph.D., Comprehending ellipsis.
Senior Data Scientist, Cisco
- 2016 Nathan Arnett, Ph.D., Subject encodings & retrieval interference.
- 2016 Chelsea A. Miller, M.A., Limited syntactic reactivation in noun phrase ellipsis.
Speech Language Pathologist Clinical Fellow, Kentfield Hospital, Kentfield, CA
- 2015 Scarlett Clothier-Goldschmidt, M.A., The distribution and processing of referential expressions: evidence from English and Chamorro.
DevOps Engineer
- 2013 Adam Morgan, M.A., Bridging the gap between production and judgment of English resumptive pronouns.
Postdoctoral Researcher, NYU Langone

TEACHING (SELECTED)

Graduate

Psycholinguistics A & B (core sequence; 2009-present)
Experimental Methods (2011-present)
Psycholinguistics Seminar (*Memory*, 2012; *Verbatim Memory & Signal Detection Theory*, 2016; *Animacy*, 2019; *Language Processing in Verb-Initial Settings*, 2022)
Syntax Seminars (*Gradience and Island Phenomena*, with Jim McCloskey, 2010, 2014)

Undergraduate

Introduction to Linguistics (2015-present)
Psycholinguistics I & II (2009-present)
Language and Mind (2015-present, generalist audience), Language and Cognition (2014-present, majors)
Syntax I (2012), Syntactic Structures (2011, 2019), Typology (2020)

Summer Institutes

Field Psycholinguistics (2023), LSA Summer Institute, with co-instructor Jed Pizarro-Guevara

SERVICE to PROFESSION

Editorial Service

- 2024- Editorial board, *Journal of Memory and Language*
- 2021- Editorial board, *Glossa Psycholinguistics*
- 2016-2022 Associate editor, *Frontiers in Psychology: Language Sciences*.
- 2013-2016 Guest Associate editor, *Frontiers in Psychology: Language Sciences*. Special topic: Encoding and navigating linguistic representations in memory.

Service in Professional Organizations

2025-present	Society for Human Sentence Processing, Executive Committee <i>Vice-President (2025-2026); incoming President (2026)</i>
2022-present	Society for Human Sentence Processing, Listserv Committee and Website Manager (2023-present)
2023	Prize Committee, Society for Human Sentence Processing, Gibson-Fedorenko Prize
2020-2022	Electorate Nominating Committee, Section Z (Linguistics and Language Science), AAAS

Conference and Meetings

2022	Co-Chair, Thirty-fifth Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing, Santa Cruz, March 24-26.
2019	Workshop Co-organizer, California Meeting on Psycholinguistics, 3, UC Santa Cruz Department of Linguistics. Santa Cruz, CA, 26-27 October.
2018	Workshop Co-organizer, 'Pronouns in Competition', Santa Cruz, April 27-28.
2013	Organizing committee, <i>Semantics and Linguistic Theory (SALT) 35</i> , Santa Cruz, May 3-5.
2013	Workshop Co-organizer, 'Memory mechanisms for structural dependency formation,' (with Brian Dillon, Colin Phillips, and Shravan Vasishth), Universität Potsdam, Potsdam, March 26.
2011	Organizing committee, <i>West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics (WCCFL) 30</i> , Santa Cruz, April 13-15.
2007	Sixteenth Annual Mayfest, Department of Linguistics, University of Maryland, College Park.
	<i>Reviewer</i> Linguistic Society of America Annual Meeting (2008-), Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing (2009-), Annual (CUNY) Conference on Human Sentence Processing (2009-), Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society (2014-), Semantics and Linguistic Theory (2014-), Chicago Linguistic Society (2016-), Northeastern Linguistic Society (2016-), California Meeting on Psycholinguistics (2018-), Formal Approaches to Japanese Linguistics (2010),

Reviewer/Referee Activity

2005-present	Cognition; Journal of Memory and Language; Language; Natural Language and Linguistic Theory; Glossa Psycholinguistics; Linguistic Inquiry; Syntax; Glossa: A Journal of General Linguistics; Journal of Experimental Psychology: Learning, Memory & Cognition; Psychonomic Bulletin and Review; Journal of Child Language; Second Language Research; Language, Cognition & Neuroscience (formerly Language and Cognitive Processes); Journal of Cultural Cognitive Science; PLoS ONE; Frontiers in Psychology; Applied Psycholinguistics; Psychophysiology; Quarterly Journal of Experimental Psychology; Cognitive Psychology; Lingua; Cognitive Science; Poznań Studies in Contemporary Linguistics; Canadian Journal of Linguistics. National Science Foundation, Israel Science Foundation, Agence National de la Recherche, Deutsche Forschungsgemeinschaft, MIT Press, Routledge Textbooks.
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SERVICE to DEPARTMENT or UNIVERSITY

2022-2026	Chair, Department of Linguistics
2025-2026	Faculty Director for Curriculum and Enrollment, Division of Humanities
2024	Acting Undergraduate Program Director, Department of Linguistics
2022-2024	Member, University Space Committee
2022-2023	Chair, Humanities Space Committee
2021-2022	Associate Chair, Department of Linguistics
2019-2022	Faculty Advisory Board, CITRIS/Banatao Institute
2019-2021	Member, Committee on Educational Policy, UCSC Academic Senate
2016-2019	Graduate Director
2017	Member, UCSC Selection Committee, Hellman Fellowship
2013-2016	Associate Graduate Director
2013-2015	Member, Committee on Research, UCSC Academic Senate
2011-2013	Member, Committee on Computing and Telecommunications, UCSC Academic Senate
2008-present	Co-Coordinator, Linguistics Labs, Linguistics Research Center

PUBLIC LECTURES and COMMUNITY OUTREACH

- 2021 Guest on radio broadcast, “Talk of the Bay,” for program, “Does language influence how you think?” Discussion of psycholinguistics and linguistic diversity, KSQD 89.5 FM, Santa Cruz, February 15, 2021.
- 2014 ‘The Chamorro language across islands and generations,’ (with Sandra Chung and Manuel F. Borja), Community forums sponsored by the Northern Marianas Humanities Council: American Memorial Park (Saipan), Office of the Mayor of Rota, and Tinian Public Library, Commonwealth of the Northern Mariana Islands, September, 2014.
- 2012 ‘Community-based scientific research on the Chamorro language,’ (with Manuel F. Borja and Sandra Chung), Public lecture sponsored by the Northern Marianas Humanities Council, American Memorial Park, Saipan, CNMI, August 14, 2012.
- Guest on radio broadcast, “Your Humanities Half-hour,” for discussion of linguistic research on the Chamorro Language, 99.5 FM, CNMI, August 12, 2012.
- ‘Bridging methodologies: experimental syntax in the Pacific,’ (co-presenter with Sandra Chung and Manuel F. Borja), Eighty-sixth Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America Presidential Address, Portland, OR, January 5-8, 2012.
- 2011 ‘Widening the Net: Challenges for gathering linguistic data in the digital age,’ (with Pranav Anand and Sandra Chung), White paper published in NSF project SBE 2020: Future Research in the Social, Behavioral & Economics Sciences.

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

- 2022-*present* Society for Human Sentence Processing
- 2013-*present* American Association for the Advancement of Science
- 2005-*present* Linguistic Society of America